

The fact that any of these conditions can develop is the reason why you'll have more prenatal checkups to preempt problems and minimize their effects.

FERTILITY TREATMENT AND MULTIPLE BIRTHS

Fertility treatment has had a huge impact on the number of multiple pregnancies. In 1977, the year before the world's first "test tube baby" was born, the natural occurrence of multiples in live births in the US was: twins 1 in 53; triplets and other multiple births, 1 in 3,092.

Today, with the increased use of fertility treatments, those numbers are 1 in 618 for triplets and other multiple births.